

Exact bounded fibres and the cost of primitive Wronskians

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Abstract

An arithmetic derivative additive on a fixed coprime equation $a + b = c$ may have a nonzero Wronskian without representing a generator of its integer image. We compare the least maximum norms for these two tasks in the original prime coordinates. For an odd prime q such that $q + 2$ has a prime divisor of exponent one, the nonzero minimum for $2 + q = q + 2$ is one, while the primitive minimum is exactly $(q - \mathcal{D})/2$ when $q + 2$ is composite and $(q + 1)/2$ when it is prime. The image generator is explicit, and the excluded prime indices have relative density zero. We also give exact bounded-fibre formulas and extend the analysis to the radical-small triples $1 + (x^N - 1) = x^N$, with $N = 4 \operatorname{rad}_{\text{odd}}(x + 1)$. A uniform comparison identifies their minimum ratio with a simultaneous modular-return problem on a positive-density set of bases. In this family the number of large active coordinates grows in density; at feasible subquadratic budgets, fixed-order frequency interactions and polynomially many explicit Fourier terms cannot certify a return outside a set of density zero. Exact certificates give the two minima for $2 + 3^{47}$ and for the bases $x = 14, 44$. Unbounded separation in the fixed-power family and in the radical-small regime remains open. No consequence for the *abc* conjecture is claimed.

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1 The two minimum problems

Let $1 \leq a \leq b$, $a+b = c > 2$, and $\gcd(a, b) = 1$. The prime supports of a, b, c are pairwise disjoint. In the model of Pasten [1, Sections 2.2 and 2.4], a derivative supported on $S = \text{supp}(abc)$ is specified by integers $z = (z_p)_{p \in S}$. Set

$$\begin{aligned} D_n(z) &= \sum_{p|n} \frac{nv_p(n)}{p} z_p, & F(z) &= D_a(z) + D_b(z) - D_c(z), \\ W(z) &= aD_b(z) - bD_a(z), & \Lambda &= \ker_{\mathbb{Z}} F, \quad \Lambda_0 = \Lambda \cap \ker_{\mathbb{Z}} W. \end{aligned} \quad (1)$$

Empty sums are zero. All norms are $\|z\|_{\infty} = \max_{p \in S} |z_p|$ in these original prime coordinates. The independent rows F, W have coefficient ratios $-b, a, 0$ on their nonempty blocks, of which there are at least two. Consequently $W(\Lambda) = \mathcal{D}\mathbb{Z}$ for some $\mathcal{D} > 0$. Define

$$m(a, b) = \min_{\substack{z \in \Lambda \\ W(z) \neq 0}} \|z\|_{\infty}, \quad m_{\text{prim}}(a, b) = \min_{\substack{z \in \Lambda \\ W(z) = \mathcal{D}}} \|z\|_{\infty}. \quad (2)$$

Both minima exist. In this paper *primitive* means a generator of the image, equivalently of Λ/Λ_0 . It does not mean merely that the coordinates of z have gcd one. Changing the sign of the specified generator does not change its minimum.

Theorem 1.1 (Exact primitive cost for almost all prime indices). *Let $q \geq 3$ be prime and suppose $c = q + 2$ is not powerful, that is, some prime divisor of c occurs with exponent one. Put $R_c = \prod_{p|c, p \nmid v_p(c)} p$ and $D = c/R_c$. Then*

$$\mathcal{D} = D, \quad m(2, q) = 1, \quad m_{\text{prim}}(2, q) = \begin{cases} (q - D)/2, & c \text{ composite,} \\ (q + 1)/2, & c \text{ prime.} \end{cases} \quad (3)$$

In the composite case every minimizer for $W = D$ has

$$z_2 = -1, \quad z_q = -(q - D)/2, \quad D_c(z) = (D - c)/2, \quad |z_p| \leq (q - D)/2 \quad (p \mid c), \quad (4)$$

and every vector satisfying these conditions is a minimizer. In the prime case the unique positive-generator minimizer is $(-1, -(q - 1)/2, -(q + 1)/2)$ in coordinates $(2, q, c)$. Among prime indices $q \leq Q$ fewer than $3\sqrt{Q} + 2$ are excluded. Thus, on a set of relative density one among primes,

$$m = 1, \quad (q - 1)/3 \leq m_{\text{prim}} \leq (q + 1)/2. \quad (5)$$

The norm-one pattern $z_2 = -1, z_q = 1$, with the c -block zero, has $F = 0, W = c$. The substantive part of the theorem is the bounded lift of the primitive value, not the mere computation of its image. The elementary case $v_3(q + 2) = 1$ is contained in its composite branch. All these triples satisfy $\text{rad}(2q(q + 2)) \geq 6q > q + 2$.

The extension to radical-small triples has a different conclusion. For $N = 4 \text{rad}_{\text{odd}}(x + 1)$ and $b = x^N - 1$, we construct an exact simultaneous-return function $h_x(u)$, with $G_x = h_x(1)$ and $\tau_x = \min_{u \geq 1} h_x(u)$. On a positive-density set of bases there is a constant C_0 , independent of x , such that

$$\frac{G_x}{C_0 \tau_x} \leq \frac{m_{\text{prim}}(1, b)}{m(1, b)} \leq \frac{C_0 G_x}{\tau_x}. \quad (6)$$

Theorem 5.2 gives the effective constant and Theorem 5.3 supplies the common domain. These statements transfer a favourable return if one is found; they do not assert unbounded G_x/τ_x . Theorems 6.2–6.5 explain an obstruction to using bounded-order spectral certificates at subquadratic budgets. Section 7 records exact finite minima, including the full $2 + 3^{47}$ certificate.

1.1 Position relative to earlier work

The derivative lattice, its norm, the additive condition and the Wronskian are inherited from Pasten [1]; in particular his Lemma 3.5 concerns nonvanishing, which is weaker than fixing the positive image generator. The row-index calculation is a specialization of determinantal divisors and Smith normal form [2, Theorem 2.4]. The complementary-weight residue and composition mechanism is present in García-Sánchez, Ojeda and Rosales [3, Proposition 1(c) and Example 12], and in the numerical-semigroup literature [4, Section 3.1][5, Proposition 5.5]. We make that mechanism explicit for signed original-coordinate bounds, including primes dividing their exponents. The covering proposition in Appendix C belongs to prescribed-sum rounding; Cont and Heidari [6] provide related optimization results.

The precise claims advanced here are the arithmetic cost formula, the simultaneous-return comparison with its explicit constants, the arithmetic growth statement and its stated certificate obstruction, and the exact original-coordinate examples. Chinese remaindering, valuation formulas, cyclotomic order arguments and positivity of Fourier autocorrelations are classical ingredients. The density-domain input is attributed to Pascadi [7], including the use of the strict margin in his weighted argument; the deduction is written out in Appendix A. The comparisons above delimit the claims; they do not constitute a guarantee of bibliographic priority.

2 Image indices and exact bounded fibres

2.1 The image generator

For $n > 1$, let

$$g_n = \gcd_{p|n} \left(\frac{nv_p(n)}{p} \right), \quad g_1 = 0.$$

Lemma 2.1 (Integer-row image calculation). *Writing $h_0 = \gcd(g_a, g_b, g_c)$, one has*

$$\mathcal{D} = \frac{\gcd(cg_ag_b, bg_ag_c, ag_bg_c)}{h_0}. \quad (7)$$

Proof. By Bézout's identity the three derivative blocks have independent images $g_a\mathbb{Z}, g_b\mathbb{Z}, g_c\mathbb{Z}$. On their product the two rows become $(g_a, g_b, -g_c)$ and $(-bg_a, ag_b, 0)$. For independent integer rows f, w , choose a unimodular matrix U with $fU = (\gcd(f), 0, \dots, 0)$. The image of w on the integral kernel is generated by the remaining entries of wU . The gcd of the two-row minors, invariant under U , is therefore $\gcd(f)$ times that generator. The three minors of the displayed rows give (7). This argument also permits the empty $a = 1$ block. $\square$

2.2 A prime block with signed coordinate caps

Fix $n = \prod_{i=1}^r p_i^{e_i} > 1$ with distinct primes p_i . Define

$$\rho_i = \gcd(p_i, e_i), \quad \ell_i = p_i/\rho_i, \quad a_i = e_i/\rho_i, \quad R = \prod_i \ell_i, \quad G = \gcd_i a_i, \quad f_i = a_i/G. \quad (8)$$

A prime dividing its own exponent has $\ell_i = 1$; it contributes no residual modulus. The nontrivial ℓ_i 's are pairwise coprime and

$$g_n = \frac{n}{R}G, \quad \frac{ne_i/p_i}{g_n} = f_i \frac{R}{\ell_i}. \quad (9)$$

Indeed the numbers $f_i R/\ell_i$ have gcd one: a common prime outside R would divide every f_i , whereas a prime $p_i \mid R$ does not divide the i -th number. This also proves the inverses used next exist.

For integers $B \geq 0, t$, write

$$\Phi_{n,B}(t) = \#\{x \in [-B, B]^r \cap \mathbb{Z}^r : D_n(x) = t\}.$$

Proposition 2.2 (Bounded block normal form). *If $g_n \nmid t$, then $\Phi_{n,B}(t) = 0$. Otherwise put $s = t/g_n$, and choose $0 \leq r_i < \ell_i$ by*

$$r_i \equiv s(f_i R / \ell_i)^{-1} \pmod{\ell_i}, \quad r_i = 0 \text{ if } \ell_i = 1.$$

Then

$$H = \frac{s - \sum_i f_i (R / \ell_i) r_i}{R}$$

is integral, and every solution is uniquely of the form

$$x_{p_i} = r_i + \ell_i y_i, \quad \sum_i f_i y_i = H, \quad y_i \in \mathbb{Z}. \quad (10)$$

The original bounds are exactly

$$L_i = \left\lceil \frac{-B - r_i}{\ell_i} \right\rceil \leq y_i \leq U_i = \left\lfloor \frac{B - r_i}{\ell_i} \right\rfloor. \quad (11)$$

If these intervals are nonempty, the count equals

$$\Phi_{n,B}(t) = [z^{H - \sum_i f_i L_i}] \prod_i \left(1 + z^{f_i} + \dots + z^{f_i(U_i - L_i)} \right). \quad (12)$$

An empty interval or a negative requested exponent gives count zero.

Proof. Divide the block equation by g_n and reduce modulo each $\ell_i > 1$. All terms except the i -th vanish, forcing its residue. The numerator defining H is divisible by every nontrivial modulus and hence by R , also when $R = 1$. Substitution gives (10), and each step is reversible. The positive coordinate steps give (11). Shift y_i by L_i and multiply the finite geometric polynomials to obtain (12). $\square$

The weighted equation in (10) is indispensable. For $n = 15, B = 1$, the block $5x_3 + 3x_5$ attains precisely

$$\{-8, -5, -3, -2, 0, 2, 3, 5, 8\}.$$

Its gcd is one and its real range is $[-8, 8]$, but it does not attain 1. Divisibility and interval membership do not replace bounded integer feasibility.

2.3 Assembly of the three source blocks

Set $A_n = \sum_{p|n} n v_p(n)/p$, with $A_1 = 0$. For an empty block put $\Phi_{1,B}(0) = 1$, with all other values zero; also interpret $\Phi_{n,B}$ at a noninteger argument as zero.

Corollary 2.3. *For any integer w , the exact number of bounded vectors with $F = 0, W = w$ is*

$$M_w(B) = \sum_{t=-BA_c}^{BA_c} \Phi_{a,B}\left(\frac{at-w}{c}\right) \Phi_{b,B}\left(\frac{bt+w}{c}\right) \Phi_{c,B}(t). \quad (13)$$

Thus m_{prim} is the first budget with $M_{\mathcal{D}}(B) > 0$, and m is the first with $M_w(B) > 0$ for some nonzero w . It suffices to inspect $|w| \leq B(aA_b + bA_a)$ and multiples of $\mathcal{D}$.

Proof. For $D_c = t$, solve $D_a + D_b = t$ and $aD_b - bD_a = w$: $D_a = (at - w)/c$, $D_b = (bt + w)/c$. The three disjoint source blocks are independent, and the values of t partition the fibre. The stated bound on w follows from the triangle inequality. $\square$

These are counts of original vectors, including their signs and nonprimitive multiples. Formula (13) is a reference description, not a polynomial-time complexity claim.

3 Proof of the prime-family theorem

For every odd prime q , the norm-one vector described after Theorem 1.1 proves $m = 1$. Under its hypothesis choose a simple prime $\ell \mid c$, meaning $v_\ell(c) = 1$. Every coefficient of D_c is divisible by $D = c/R_c$. The normalized coefficient at ℓ is R_c/ℓ . A common prime divisor of all normalized coefficients would therefore be some $p \mid R_c$, $p \neq \ell$; but the coefficient $(R_c/p)v_p(c)$ is a unit modulo p . Hence $g_c = D$. The equation $F = 0$ is equivalent to $z_2 + z_q \in D\mathbb{Z}$, with every such source pair liftable by Bézout. Writing $z_q = Dt - z_2$ gives $W = 2Dt - cz_2$, whose image is $D\mathbb{Z}$ since c/D is odd.

Suppose first that c is composite. Then $D \leq c/3 < q$. The primitive source equation $2z_q - qz_2 = D$ makes z_2 odd. For $z_2 \geq 1$, $z_q \geq (q + D)/2$; for $z_2 \leq -1$, $|z_q| \geq (q - D)/2 =: B$, with equality only when $z_2 = -1$, $z_q = -B$. It remains to lift the target $D_c = (D - c)/2$ inside the same cube.

Write $c = \ell v$ and $r = \sum_{p \mid v} v_p(v) \geq 1$; here $v \geq 3$ and $\ell \nmid v$. Put $R = R_c$ and $L = (1 - R)/2$. For each active $p \neq \ell$, choose the centered representative of $(Rv_p(c)/p)z_p \equiv L \pmod{p}$; set inactive coordinates to zero. The pivot

$$z_\ell = \frac{L - \sum_{p \mid R, p \neq \ell} (Rv_p(c)/p)z_p}{R/\ell}$$

is integral by reduction modulo every prime of R/ℓ , and the target row equals DL . Since $D \leq v$, $B \geq ((\ell - 1)v - 2)/2 \geq v - 1$; every nonpivot coordinate is at most $(v - 1)/2$. For the pivot,

$$|z_\ell| \leq \ell|L|/R + \ell \sum_{p \mid R, p \neq \ell} v_p(c)|z_p|/p < \ell(1 + r)/2.$$

If $\ell \geq 5$, $v \geq 3^r$ and $\ell(1 + r) \leq (\ell - 1)3^r - 2 \leq (\ell - 1)v - 2$. The first inequality holds at $r = 1$; its right-hand increment $2(\ell - 1)3^r$ exceeds the left-hand increment ℓ . If $\ell = 3$, $v \geq 5^r$, and the same induction gives $3(1 + r) \leq 2 \cdot 5^r - 2 \leq 2v - 2$. Thus the pivot also lies in the cube of radius B . This proves the composite formula and the optimizer description.

If c is prime, $D = 1$ and $z_c = z_2 + z_q$. The choice $z_2 = -1$ gives the stated vector of norm $(q + 1)/2$. Positive odd z_2 forces $z_c \geq (q + 3)/2$; $z_2 \leq -3$ forces $|z_q| \geq (3q - 1)/2 > (q + 1)/2$. This proves uniqueness, also for $q = 3$.

Every powerful integer has a unique representation a^2b^3 with b squarefree: the primes in b are precisely those with odd exponent. The number at most T is bounded by $\sqrt{T} \sum_{b \geq 1} b^{-3/2} < 3\sqrt{T}$. For completeness $\pi(Q) \gg Q/\log Q$ follows elementarily from

$$\frac{4^n}{2n + 1} \leq \binom{2n}{n} \leq (2n)^{\pi(2n)} :$$

Legendre's formula bounds the exponent of p in the binomial coefficient by $\lfloor \log_p(2n) \rfloor$. Taking $n = \lfloor Q/2 \rfloor$ proves that the relative exceptional proportion is $O(\log Q/\sqrt{Q})$. The inequalities in (5) follow from $D \leq c/3$ in the composite branch. This completes the proof of Theorem 1.1.

Remark 3.1 (Necessary boundary distinctions). At $q = 3, c = 5$, the primitive minimum is 2, not the composite expression 1. At $q = 47, c = 49$, $D_c = 14z_7$ and $\mathcal{D} = 7$. The putative composite cost 20 forces $z_2 = -1, z_q = -20$ and $D_c = -21$, which is impossible. The vector $(1, 27, 2)$ has primitive norm 27; the source equation excludes any smaller value except the already impossible source pair. Thus the nonpowerful hypothesis cannot simply be dropped.

4 A radical-small family and its image

Write $\mathfrak{h}(n) = n/\text{rad}(n)$ for $n \geq 1$, with $\mathfrak{h}(1) = 1$. For an integer $x \geq 2$, fix

$$N = N(x) = 4\text{rad}_{\text{odd}}(x + 1) = \text{lcm}(4, \text{rad}(x + 1)), \quad b = x^N - 1, \quad C = Nx^{N-1}. \quad (14)$$

Here rad_{odd} omits the prime 2. The derivative coordinates of x^N are the prime coordinates of x , and $D_{x^N} = CD_x$. For the triple $1 + b = x^N$, the equations are therefore

$$D_b = CD_x, \quad W = D_b. \quad (15)$$

All constants and residues below refer to this particular base x .

Proposition 4.1 (Radical inequality and exact image). *For (14),*

$$x + 1 \mid \mathfrak{h}(b), \quad \text{rad}(xb) \leq \frac{xb}{x+1} < x^N. \quad (16)$$

Writing $g_n = \gcd_{p|n}(nv_p(n)/p)$, the integer values of D_x allowed by (15) are precisely $\Delta\mathbb{Z}$, where

$$\Delta = \frac{g_x g_b}{\gcd(g_b, Cg_x)}, \quad \mathcal{D} = C\Delta. \quad (17)$$

If b has a simple prime, define, for $p \mid b$,

$$s_p = \begin{cases} v_p(x^{\text{ord}_p(x)} - 1) - 1, & p \text{ odd}, \\ v_2(x-1) + v_2(x+1) - 2, & p = 2, \end{cases} \quad H = \prod_{p|b} p^{s_p}, \quad I = \prod_{\substack{p|b \\ p \nmid v_p(b)}} p.$$

Then $s_p \geq 0$, $v_p(b) = 1 + v_p(N) + s_p$, and

$$\Delta = \text{lcm}(g_x, HI), \quad H \mid \Delta, \quad \mathfrak{h}(x) \leq g_x \leq \Delta. \quad (18)$$

If also x has a simple prime, $\Delta = g_x HI$.

Proof. For odd $p \mid x + 1$, the lifting-the-exponent identity gives $v_p(b) = v_p(x + 1) + v_p(N)$; hence $v_p(\mathfrak{h}(b)) \geq v_p(x + 1)$ exactly when $p \mid N$. For odd x , the identity at 2 is $v_2(b) = v_2(x - 1) + v_2(x + 1) + v_2(N) - 1$, and $4 \mid N$ suffices. These prove the divisibility and radical estimate. They also show that among multiples of 4, the least exponent giving this *divisibility* is $N(x)$. This is not a claim of a least exponent for the radical inequality itself.

The two row images are $g_x\mathbb{Z}, g_b\mathbb{Z}$. Their intersection condition is $D_x \in g_x\mathbb{Z}$ and $CD_x \in g_b\mathbb{Z}$, yielding (17). For odd $p \mid b$, $\text{ord}_p(x) \mid N$ and is coprime to p ; the valuation formula follows by lifting the exponent. The displayed formula for 2 follows from $v_2(N) = 2$. If b has a simple prime, its normalized exponent gcd in (8) is one, so $g_b = b / \prod_{p|b, p \nmid v_p(b)} p$. At a prime $p \mid b$, $p \nmid x$ and $v_p(C) = v_p(N)$. Thus the exponent contributed by $g_b / \gcd(g_b, C)$ is $s_p + \mathbf{1}_{p|v_p(b)}$. At primes not dividing b it is zero. Combining with g_x proves the lcm formula. Every coefficient in the x row is divisible by $\mathfrak{h}(x)$, and $g_x \mid \Delta$. If x has a simple prime its row gcd is supported on x , which is coprime to b , proving the last assertion. $\square$

An explicit large phase is available: if $P > x$ divides $x^2 + 1$, then $\text{ord}_P(x) = 4$, $P \nmid N$, and $v_P(x^2 + 1) = 1$. Consequently P is simple in b . With $Q = (x^2 + 1)/P$, reduction of the identity $(X^N - 1) = (X^2 + 1)U(X)$ and its formal derivative at x gives

$$Qz_P \equiv 2xD_x \pmod{P}. \quad (19)$$

Indeed $Nx^{N-1} \equiv 2xU(x) \pmod{P}$ and $b/P = QU(x)$, with $U(x)$ a unit. In this differentiation N is held fixed. The prime-factor theorem of Pascadi [7, Theorem 1] supplies infinitely many such $P > x^{1.3}$. A large modulus alone does not establish a favourable return or a gap in the minima.

5 Uniform lifting of all simultaneous phases

For a row $D_n = \sum_i A_i z_i$, put $S_n = \sum_i A_i$. Use the normalized data of (8) and write $A_i/g_n = f_i R/\ell_i$. An index j with $f_j = 1$ is called a *unit anchor*. A simple prime is always a unit anchor. For $T \in g_n \mathbb{Z}$, let $r_i(T)$ be the centered representative of

$$r_i(T) \equiv (T/g_n)(A_i/g_n)^{-1} \pmod{\ell_i}, \quad (20)$$

and set $r_i = 0$ if $\ell_i = 1$. For even modulus use the representative in $(-\ell_i/2, \ell_i/2]$; either tie has the same absolute value. These are residues of the full row, prior to any choice of a source-zero section or projection.

Lemma 5.1 (A drift-balanced lift). *Suppose row n has unit anchor j , and put $\alpha = T/S_n$. If $B \geq |\alpha|$ and $B \geq |r_i(T)|$ for every $i \neq j$, there is an integer lift of T with*

$$|z_i| \leq 3B \quad (i \neq j), \quad |z_j| \leq |\alpha| + \frac{p_j}{e_j} V_n(B), \quad V_n(B) = \sum_{i \neq j} \frac{e_i}{p_i} \min\{\ell_i/2, 2B\}. \quad (21)$$

Conversely any lift has norm at least $\max(|\alpha|, \max_{i \neq j} |r_i(T)|)$.

Proof. For $i \neq j$, choose a representative in $r_i(T) + \ell_i \mathbb{Z}$ nearest to α . Its distance to α is at most $\ell_i/2$ and at most $2B$, since $r_i(T)$ is itself an admissible comparison. The anchor value $z_j = (T - \sum_{i \neq j} A_i z_i)/A_j$ is integral: after division by g_n , its numerator is divisible by every nontrivial modulus in $R/\ell_j = A_j/g_n$. Subtract the real solution with all coordinates α to obtain (21). The lower bounds follow from the positive row coefficients and from its congruences. The proof also covers $\ell_j = 1$. $\square$

For (14), choose a unit anchor in each of the rows x, b . Assume that b has a simple prime. List *all* active nonanchor coordinates of the two rows; their moduli are denoted p_i . Their residues at targets $\Delta, C\Delta$ are κ_i . The list may contain zeros. Define

$$\begin{aligned} \mu &= \max\{\Delta/S_x, C\Delta/S_b\}, & \rho(u) &= \max_i |\langle u \kappa_i \rangle_{p_i}|, \\ h_x(u) &= \max\{\mu u, \rho(u)\}, & G_x &= h_x(1), \quad \tau_x = \min_{u \geq 1} h_x(u), \end{aligned} \quad (22)$$

where $\langle \cdot \rangle_p$ denotes the centered representative, and the maximum of an empty phase list is zero. Let $m_x(u)$ be the least original norm with $D_x = u\Delta$ and $D_b = uC\Delta$. These are positive image indices; sign symmetry gives $m(1, b) = \min_{u \geq 1} m_x(u)$ and $m_{\text{prim}}(1, b) = m_x(1)$. The minimum defining τ_x exists because $\mu > 0$.

Theorem 5.2 (Uniform original-coordinate comparison). *Put*

$$H_0 = \mathfrak{h}(x-1)\mathfrak{h}(x+1)\mathfrak{h}(x^2+1), \quad \sigma_n = \sum_{p|n} 1/p, \quad \vartheta_n = p_{j_n}/e_{j_n}, \quad J = H_0(\sigma_b + 1)/2,$$

where j_x, j_b are the chosen unit anchors, and set

$$C_x = \max\{3, 1 + \vartheta_x(2\sigma_x + J), 1 + \vartheta_b(4\sigma_b + 2 + J)\}. \quad (23)$$

For every positive integer u ,

$$h_x(u) \leq m_x(u) \leq C_x h_x(u). \quad (24)$$

In particular

$$\tau_x \leq m(1, b) \leq C_x \tau_x, \quad G_x \leq m_{\text{prim}}(1, b) \leq C_x G_x, \quad \frac{G_x}{C_x \tau_x} \leq \frac{m_{\text{prim}}(1, b)}{m(1, b)} \leq \frac{C_x G_x}{\tau_x}. \quad (25)$$

If $H_0 \leq K$, $\sigma_x + \sigma_b \leq L$ and $\vartheta_x, \vartheta_b \leq Y$, one may use the base-independent constant

$$C_0 = \max\{3, 1 + Y(4L + 2 + K(L + 1)/2)\}. \quad (26)$$

No bound on Δ or on the sum of moduli is assumed.

Proof. Write $t = \log_2 \Delta$ and $\lambda_b = \sum_{p|b} v_p(b)/p$. Equation (18), and $v_p(N) = 1$ at odd primes dividing N while $v_2(N) = 2$, imply

$$\lambda_b \leq 2\sigma_b + 1 + t/2. \quad (27)$$

Indeed $\sum s_p \leq t$ and $p \geq 2$. Since $N\mathfrak{h}(x+1) \geq 2(x+1)$, also $NH_0 \geq 2(x+1)$. As $b < x^N$ and $S_b = b\lambda_b$,

$$\mu \geq \frac{C\Delta}{S_b} > \frac{2\Delta}{H_0\lambda_b}.$$

For $t \geq 0$, $t/2^t \leq 1$ and $t^2/2^t \leq 2$; these follow by maximizing the two elementary real functions. Consequently

$$\frac{t}{2\mu} < \frac{H_0 t (2\sigma_b + 1 + t/2)}{4 \cdot 2^t} \leq H_0(\sigma_b + 1)/2 = J$$

when $t > 0$, and the same non-strict bound holds at $t = 0$.

For the source row, split each e_p into $1 + (e_p - 1)$. The first part contributes at most $2\sigma_x B$ to $V_x(B)$, and the second at most $\frac{1}{2} \sum (e_p - 1) \leq t/2$, since $\mathfrak{h}(x) \leq \Delta$. For the target row use $e_p = 1 + v_p(N) + s_p$: the first two parts contribute at most $(4\sigma_b + 2)B$, including the prime 2, and the last at most $t/2$. Thus, whenever $B \geq \mu$,

$$V_x(B) \leq (2\sigma_x + J)B, \quad V_b(B) \leq (4\sigma_b + 2 + J)B.$$

Apply Lemma 5.1 to both rows at $B = h_x(u) \geq \mu$. Their coordinates are disjoint, and their targets use the same u . This proves (24). Taking minima and dividing the appropriate upper and lower bounds gives (25). The constant occurs once, not squared. Formula (26) follows by enlarging the three parameters. $\square$

Theorem 5.3 (A common positive-density domain). *Fix $1 < \alpha < 1.3$. There are finite constants K, L, Y such that a set of bases of positive lower density satisfies all of the following:*

1. $H_0 \leq K$ and $\sigma_x + \sigma_b \leq L$;
2. x and $b = x^{N(x)} - 1$ each have a simple prime at most Y ;
3. $x^2 + 1$ has a prime divisor $P > x^\alpha$.

Hence (25) holds there with the same C_0 .

The proof, with the analytic input and the order of parameter choices specified, is given in Appendix A. It uses subtraction of exceptional sets of arbitrarily small upper density from a positive-density prime-factor set. It does not intersect unrelated positive-density sets without further information.

5.1 What an unbounded separation would require

On any domain with fixed C_0 , the ratio m_{prim}/m is unbounded along a sequence if and only if G_x/τ_x is. A sufficient and necessary return formulation along such a sequence is the existence of indices $u = u(x)$ with

$$\mu_x u / G_x \longrightarrow 0, \quad \max_i |\langle u \kappa_i(x) \rangle_{p_i(x)}| / G_x \longrightarrow 0. \quad (28)$$

All phases in this display belong to the same base and the same index.

Proposition 5.4 (First-wrap obstruction). *For a nonzero centered phase $\theta = |\kappa|$ modulo p ,*

$$\tau_x \geq \min\{\theta, \mu p / (\theta + \mu)\}.$$

If $G_x = \mu$, then $\tau_x = G_x$ and $m_{\text{prim}}/m \leq C_x$. Otherwise let p_ be the largest modulus among phases with $|\kappa_i| = G_x$. Then*

$$\frac{m_{\text{prim}}}{m} \leq C_x \max\{1, G_x(G_x + \mu) / (\mu p_*)\}. \quad (29)$$

Proof. If $h_x(u) = B < \theta$, the residue bound cannot hold before the first wrap: $u\theta \geq p - B$. Since $u \leq B/\mu$, this forces $B \geq \mu p/(\theta + \mu)$. Otherwise $B \geq \theta$ already. Apply this to $\theta = G_x$, or use $h_x(u) \geq \mu u$ when $G_x = \mu$, and then (25). $\square$

In addition $\tau_x \geq \mu$, so unbounded separation with fixed C_0 requires both G_x/μ and the second capacity in (29) to become unbounded. These conditions are necessary, not sufficient.

6 Growing arithmetic dimension and sparse certificates

This section concerns the family (14). Density statements use ordinary counting of integer bases: an exceptional set has size $o(X)$ up to X , even when the ambient domain itself is restricted. They do not assert independence of its modular phases.

Lemma 6.1 (Cyclotomic blocks). *Let $x \geq 5$, $n = \text{rad}_{\text{odd}}(x+1)$, and $d \mid n$, $d \geq 3$. If $(2d+1)^2 > x+1$, each of the three orders $d, 2d, 4d$ is realized by a distinct active prime of $b = x^{4n} - 1$. These primes are at least $2d+1, 2d+1, 4d+1$, respectively. An active prime means $p \nmid v_p(b)$.*

Proof. For an odd prime $p \nmid x$, put $f = \text{ord}_p(x)$ and $a = v_p(x^f - 1)$. The factorization into cyclotomic polynomials and the valuation formula $v_p(x^{ft} - 1) = a + v_p(t)$ give

$$v_p(\Phi_m(x)) = \begin{cases} a, & m = f, \\ 1, & m = fp^j \ (j \geq 1), \\ 0, & \text{otherwise.} \end{cases}$$

This follows by induction on the divisors in $x^m - 1 = \prod_{e \mid m} \Phi_e(x)$. For $p = 2$, an index $m \geq 3$ can contribute only when m is a power of two, in which case the valuation is one. For the three indices here this does not occur. If $m = fp^j$, then $f \mid p-1$, so p is the largest prime factor of m . Thus the product of the nonprimitive prime contributions to $\Phi_m(x)$ is at most m . But the root factorization gives

$$(x-1)^{\varphi(m)} \leq \Phi_m(x) \leq (x+1)^{\varphi(m)}.$$

For $m = d, 2d$, $\varphi(m) \geq 2$ and $(x-1)^2 > 2(x+1)$; for $m = 4d$, $\varphi(m) \geq 4$ and $(x-1)^4 > 4(x+1)$. Since $d \leq x+1$, these bounds exceed m and force a primitive prime with exact order m .

Such a prime satisfies $p \equiv 1 \pmod{m}$; parity improves the lower bound at odd order d to $2d+1$. It does not divide N : odd primes dividing N divide $x+1$ and have order at most two. Its exponent in b is therefore its exponent in $\Phi_m(x)$. In all three cases $\varphi(m) < p/2$, while $p^2 > x+1$; hence $(x+1)^{\varphi(m)} < p^p$. Its positive exponent is less than p , so it is active. Exact orders make all primes from distinct indices different; odd d also separates the three types of index. $\square$

Theorem 6.2 (Growing active rank in density). *Fix $K \geq 1$, $0 < \beta < 1$ and an integer $q \geq 1$. Outside $o(X)$ exceptions among $x \leq X$ with $H_0(x) \leq K$, the row of b has at least q distinct active primes greater than x^β . After deleting any fixed number of coordinates, the product of remaining active moduli exceeds every fixed power of x in the same density sense.*

Proof. For fixed Y , let $Z_Y(x)$ count the odd primes $p \leq Y$ dividing $x+1$, and let $A_Y = \sum_{3 \leq p \leq Y} 1/p$. CRT over a fixed finite set gives mean A_Y and variance at most A_Y in the limiting density. Since $A_Y \rightarrow \infty$, for each fixed s the upper density of $Z_Y < s$ is at most $A_Y/(A_Y - s)^2$, tending to zero with Y . If $Z_Y \geq s$, choose s of those primes and let their product be $Q_0 \mid Q_Y = \prod_{3 \leq p \leq Y} p$. Since $n \geq (x+1)/(2K)$, every $t \mid Q_0$ gives a distinct divisor $d = n/t \geq (x+1)/(2KQ_Y)$. With K, Y fixed, for sufficiently large x these 2^s divisors satisfy the previous lemma and give $3 \cdot 2^s$ active primes greater than x^β . First choose s for the requested q , then let Y grow to make the upper exceptional density arbitrarily small. This proves a zero-density exception. For the product claim choose q larger than the number removed plus the requested power divided by β . No growing- q rate is asserted. $\square$

Lemma 6.3 (Simple phases at feasible short budgets). *Fix K, Y , $0 \leq \theta < \beta < 2$ and $q \geq 1$. Outside $o(X)$ exceptions among bases $x \leq X$ with $H_0 \leq K$ and simple anchors at most Y in both rows, the following alternative holds: either there are no real budgets B and integer horizons $H \geq 1$ with $\mu H \leq B \leq x^\theta$, or the global phase list contains at least q distinct nonzero simple nonanchor phases with modulus $p > x^\beta$. Each has $p \nmid \Delta$ and $p > 2B$ for all large x .*

Proof. We give the size estimates to specify the quantifiers. First

$$\lambda_b < 4 \log_2(2x\Delta), \quad \mu > \frac{\Delta}{2K \log_2(2x\Delta)} \geq \frac{1}{2K \log_2(2x)}. \quad (30)$$

Indeed $\mathfrak{h}(b) = \prod p^{v_p(N)+s_p}$ divides NH , so is at most $N\Delta$. Split $\lambda_b = \sigma_b + \sum(e_p - 1)/p$. With $A = \log_2 b$, primes $p \leq A$ contribute at most $1 + \log A$ to σ_b , and those above A contribute at most $\omega(b)/A \leq 1$; also $\sum(e_p - 1)/p \leq \frac{1}{2} \log_2(N\Delta)$. Using $N \leq 4(x+1)$ gives the first (loose) bound for $x \geq 5$. The earlier lower bound $\mu > 2\Delta/(K\lambda_b)$ proves the second. The last inequality follows from $\log_2(2x\Delta) \leq \Delta \log_2(2x)$ for $\Delta \geq 1$. Thus feasibility forces $\Delta < x^\gamma$ eventually for every fixed $\gamma > \theta$: otherwise the increasing function $t/\log_2(2xt)$ at $t = x^\gamma$ would contradict $\mu \leq x^\theta$.

We strengthen the cyclotomic size argument on the domain $\Delta \leq x^D$, for any fixed D . Choose the large orders $m = d, 2d, 4d$ in the proof of Theorem 6.2, so $m \gg x$ with constants fixed before x grows. Suppose all primitive primes of $\Phi_m(x)$ are at most $Z = x^\beta$. There are at most $\lfloor (Z-1)/m \rfloor$ such primes, since each is $1 \pmod{m}$. Their repeated parts divide $H \mid \Delta$, and the nonprimitive part is at most m . Hence

$$(x-1)^{\varphi(m)} \leq \Phi_m(x) \leq m\Delta Z^{\lfloor (Z-1)/m \rfloor}. \quad (31)$$

For every $\varepsilon > 0$ one has $\varphi(m) \geq c_\varepsilon m^{1-\varepsilon}$: in the product for $\varphi(m)m^{\varepsilon-1}$, only finitely many primes can give a factor smaller than one. Choose $\varepsilon < 2 - \beta$. The logarithm of the left side of (31) is $\gg x^{1-\varepsilon} \log x$, whereas that of the right side is $O(\log x + x^{\beta-1} \log x)$, a contradiction. Thus every one of arbitrarily many fixed large orders supplies a prime $p > x^\beta$. At most $\lfloor D/\beta \rfloor$ of these distinct primes can be repeated, because then each divides $H \mid \Delta \leq x^D$. Start with enough orders to leave q simple ones. The fixed- Y CRT argument again makes the exceptional count $o(X)$, without asserting any density for the feasible branch.

Choose $\theta < \gamma < \beta$ and use feasibility to put $\Delta < x^\gamma$. At the remaining simple primes, $p \nmid \Delta$ and eventually $p > Y, 2B$. To check that their *global* phase is nonzero, note that with simple primes in both rows,

$$\Delta = \epsilon_0 g_x g_b / N, \quad C\Delta / g_b = \epsilon_0 g_x x^{N-1}, \quad \epsilon_0 = \begin{cases} 1, & x \text{ odd}, \\ 4, & x \text{ even}. \end{cases}$$

Here g_x is supported on x , and $\gcd(g_b, C) = N/\epsilon_0$ by the local valuations in Proposition 4.1. The right side is a unit at each new prime p , as is its normalized row coefficient. Its residue (20) is therefore nonzero. $\square$

6.1 What positivity can certify

Let a finite list of phases be (p_i, κ_i) , let $H \geq 1$, $M = H+1$, and choose integer lengths $1 \leq L_i \leq p_i$. On $\mathbb{Z}/p_i\mathbb{Z}$ set

$$f_i(z) = \frac{1}{L_i} \#\{(a, b) \in \{0, \dots, L_i - 1\}^2 : a - b = z\}, \quad V_L(t) = \left| \frac{1}{L} \sum_{a=0}^{L-1} e^{2\pi i a t} \right|^2, \quad D_i = L_i/p_i.$$

Thus $0 \leq f_i \leq 1$ and $f_i(0) = 1$.

Proposition 6.4 (Positive Fourier identity and finite caps). *The energy*

$$\begin{aligned}\mathcal{E} &= \frac{1}{M} \sum_{a,b=0}^H \prod_i f_i((a-b)\kappa_i) \\ &= M \prod_i D_i \sum_{m_i \bmod p_i} V_M \left(\sum_i \frac{m_i \kappa_i}{p_i} \right) \prod_i V_{L_i}(m_i/p_i)\end{aligned}\quad (32)$$

has nonnegative summands and diagonal contribution one in its first expression. Therefore a lower certificate $\mathcal{E} > 1$ yields some $1 \leq u \leq H$ with $|\langle u \kappa_i \rangle_{p_i}| \leq L_i - 1$ for every i . For any q designated coordinates with $D_i \leq \delta$, the total mass of all frequency terms involving at most $r \leq q$ of these coordinates is at most

$$M \binom{q}{r} \delta^{q-r}. \quad (33)$$

Any T individually listed distinct frequency terms have mass at most

$$TM\delta^q. \quad (34)$$

These bounds allow arbitrary frequencies in the undesigned coordinates.

Proof. Finite Fourier inversion gives $\widehat{f}_i(m) = D_i V_{L_i}(m/p_i)$. The normalized sum over a, b gives MV_M and proves the identity. If the energy exceeds its diagonal, an off-diagonal product is positive, so each difference is represented by two interval elements, giving the claimed centered bound.

Fix a subset J of r designated coordinates and set the other $q - r$ frequencies to zero. Removing their factors D_i leaves the full Fourier energy of the remaining coordinates, at most M by the time expression and $f_i \leq 1$. Cover all supports of size at most r by the $\binom{q}{r}$ choices of J and use positivity; this proves (33), even though the cover can overlap. For a single term $V_L \leq 1$ and each undesigned $D_i \leq 1$, so it is at most $M\delta^q$. Summing T terms proves the second cap. $\square$

Theorem 6.5 (A restricted spectral-certificate barrier). *Fix K, Y , $0 \leq \theta < 2$, an interaction order $r \geq 0$ and $c \geq 0$. Consider bases with $H_0 \leq K$ and simple anchors at most Y , and feasible budgets $\mu H \leq B \leq x^\theta$, $H \geq 1$. Use all global phases and $L_i = \min(p_i, \lfloor B \rfloor + 1)$. Outside $o(X)$ bases up to X , uniformly over these feasible choices, neither the complete collection of terms of fixed interaction order r nor any at most x^c individually listed distinct terms has mass exceeding one in (32); in fact their masses tend to zero. For the first assertion it suffices to count interactions within an appropriate fixed number of designated large coordinates.*

Proof. If $\theta = 0$, (30) still gives the following bound; otherwise the same calculation applies. Fix $\theta < \beta < 2$. By Lemma 6.3 choose any required fixed number q of nonzero simple phases $p_i > x^\beta$, outside $o(X)$ exceptions. Then $D_i \leq 2x^{\theta-\beta}$ and $M = O_K(x^\theta \log x)$ by (30). Choose $q > r + \theta/(\beta - \theta)$ in (33), and $q > (c + \theta)/(\beta - \theta)$ in (34). Both bounds tend to zero. The number q is fixed before the density limit, and the bounds use only the displayed budget inequalities, so are uniform in B, H . $\square$

This is a limit on two specified positive-sum certificates. It is not an upper bound for the full energy, an absence-of-returns theorem, or a general algorithmic lower bound. It leaves open exceptional bases, budgets $o(G_x)$ larger than a fixed subquadratic scale, and collective frequency mass with increasing support. Lemma 6.3 does not assert that feasible subquadratic budgets have positive density.

7 Finite certificates in the original coordinates

The ordinary proofs above establish their universal statements. The finite results in this section additionally use supplied exact data and a short standard-library verifier. No floating-point optimization, probable-prime declaration or assumed factorization is used in their acceptance checks.

Theorem 7.1 (Two variable-base minima). *For $b = x^{60} - 1$, with the original coordinates and primitive meaning of (2), the following minima hold:*

x	Δ	u at a useful minimizer	$m(1, b)$	$m_{\text{prim}}(1, b)$
14	1	331476352	1054020192	311136274396595031
44	36	1807554653	70930543252	92514302310809204735

Here $N(x) = 60$ in both cases, so both triples satisfy $\text{rad}(xb) < x^{60}$. The ratios are approximately $2.95 \cdot 10^8$ and $1.30 \cdot 10^9$, respectively.

Certificate verification. The file `companion/data/exact_minima.json` gives complete factorizations, row anchors, integer vectors and lattice bases. Its prime certificates are in `companion/data/minima_primes.json`. The program `companion/verify_finite.py` performs the following exact certificate proof, whose exhaustiveness we specify here.

Each prime $p > 2$ is certified by a complete factorization of $p - 1$ into previously certified primes and an integer a such that $a^{p-1} = 1 \pmod{p}$ and $\gcd(a^{(p-1)/r} - 1, p) = 1$ for every prime $r \mid p - 1$. For any prime divisor $s \mid p$, these conditions force the order of $a \pmod{s}$ to be $p - 1$, so $s \geq p$ and p is prime. Multiplication then verifies each whole factorization and reconstructs all original rows, their image and the global phases.

For a proposed lower budget $B = m - 1$, a possible positive index obeys $1 \leq u \leq \lfloor B/\mu \rfloor$ and every centered phase is at most B . Choose the specified pivot (p, κ) with $p > 2B$. A displayed integer basis $(q, r), (s, t)$ has determinant p and lies in the congruence lattice $z = \kappa u \pmod{p}$; it is therefore a basis of the whole lattice. Write $(u, z) = a(q, r) + v(s, t)$. The inverse coordinate $v = (qz - ru)/p$ has its extrema at the four rectangle corners $1 \leq u \leq \lfloor B/\mu \rfloor$, $-B \leq z \leq B$. Enumerating every integer v in this interval and the corresponding complete interval of a lists every possible index. Every remaining global phase is then tested, not just the pivot phase.

For $x = 44$ no index survives. For $x = 14$ the sole survivor is $u = 331476352$. Proposition 2.2, applied to both original cubes, rejects it: the target-row carry is 1420612936, whereas the upper possible carry is 1420612934, a deficit of two. In these two inputs the normalized weights are only one or two. Their interval sum is the whole interval from its lower to upper endpoint if any weight-one coordinate is flexible; otherwise it is the corresponding parity class. This checks the carries exhaustively. The displayed vectors attain m at the asserted indices.

At $u = 1$, the computed lower bound $\lceil G_x \rceil$ equals the listed m_{prim} in each case, and the supplied primitive vectors attain it. All row equations, coordinates, norms and image values are checked as integers. These prove both minima, not only upper bounds. $\square$

For $x = 14$, the winning index is 4 (mod 7). A section forcing the nonanchor source coordinate to zero would require $u = 0 \pmod{7}$ and miss it. The return minimum also differs from the original minimum: $\lceil \tau_{14} \rceil = m - 5$, while $\tau_{44} = m$. These are concrete reasons to retain the source phases and the final integer carry when using a reduced return problem.

7.1 Finite mixed-frequency certificates

Two companion benchmarks illustrate the role of mixed frequencies in Proposition 6.4. The variable-base case $x = 6, N = 28$ at return budget $B = 11000, H = 1307$ has

$$\mathcal{E} = 3440888017/2931421802 > 1, \quad \mathcal{E}_{\text{axes}} = 41388640220693/61401273111326 < 1.$$

The fixed-power case $k = 53$, on its specified normalized return section at $B = 2000000$, $H = 400000$, has

$$\mathcal{E} = \frac{2073236796034760609}{1600005600004400001} > 1,$$

$$\mathcal{E}_{\text{axes}} = \frac{91767038289310419629485}{156111755376230439915667} < 1.$$

The first uses 23 explicit frequency terms, 20 mixed; the second uses 11, 10 mixed. Their certified lower scores exceed 1281/1250 and 5249/5000. The axis mass means all terms supported on either of the two restrictive axes, with the zero term counted once. All other phases are automatically paid by the declared budget. The data include original-coordinate witnesses and their separate norm bounds; a return budget is not identified with an original norm.

For reproducibility, the verifier both sums the rational time-domain energy and checks rational lower bounds for the selected frequencies. If $a = \text{dist}(t, \mathbb{Z})$, $d = \text{dist}(Lt, \mathbb{Z})$ and $a \neq 0$, a lower bound for $V_L(t)$ is the maximum of zero,

$$1 - \frac{10}{3}(L^2 - 1)a^2, \quad \left[\frac{d}{La} \left(1 - \frac{5}{3}d^2 + \frac{5}{6}d^4 - \frac{25}{126}d^6 \right) \right]^2.$$

At $a = 0$ the value is one. The first estimate follows from the cosine lower bound in the squared exponential sum and $\pi^2 < 10$. For the second use $\sin(\pi a) \leq \pi a$ and the alternating seventh-degree sine lower bound on $0 \leq \pi d \leq \pi/2$; its bracket decreases with π^2 on this range, so substitution of 10 gives the displayed smaller positive polynomial. These finite successes concern two restrictive phases. They do not contradict the growing-dimensional statement of Theorem 6.5.

8 A compact exact certificate for $2 + 3^{47}$

The large example can be checked without enumerating a large cube. Its certificate consists of a factorization, a two-dimensional lattice basis, a small affine deficit and a primitive congruence.

Theorem 8.1. *For $a = 2, b = 3^{47}$, in the norm of (2),*

$$m = 6493223, \quad m_{\text{prim}} = 1358381707976.$$

There are exactly twenty vectors attaining m , with Wronskian values $\pm 133972\mathcal{D}$. All vectors attaining m_{prim} with $W = \mathcal{D}$ are parametrized in (39) below. This is a radical-small triple: $\text{rad}(abc)/c = 6/343$.

8.1 Model and integral projected coordinates

Use the factorization

$$3^{47} + 2 = 7^4 \cdot 11 \cdot 59 \cdot 4691 \cdot 3637447066471. \quad (35)$$

Each displayed factor is prime; the companion verifies this by exhaustive trial division up to its integer square root, and verifies the product. Put

$$P = 3637447066471, \quad d = 7 \cdot 11 \cdot 59 \cdot 4691 = 21311213, \quad h = 343,$$

$$T = 3^{46} = 8862938119652501095929, \quad c = hdP = 3T + 2,$$

$$L = d + 2(4d/7 + d/11 + d/59 + d/4691) = 50273151.$$

The coordinate order is $(2, 3, 7, 11, 59, 4691, P)$. The rows are $F = x_2 + 47Tx_3 - D_c$ and $W = T(94x_3 - 3x_2)$. Since $g_c = h$, formula (7) gives $\mathcal{D} = Th$.

For any integral additive vector set

$$j = (3x_2 - 94x_3)/h, \quad v = x_P.$$

These are integral: reducing $3F = 0$ modulo h , and using $3T \equiv -2 \pmod{h}$, proves the divisibility in j . Elimination gives $W = -Thj$ and

$$j \equiv 3dv \pmod{P}, \quad |v| \leq B, \quad |Tj + 2dv| \leq PLB \quad (36)$$

whenever $\|x\|_\infty \leq B$. Indeed, $Tj/(dP) = x_2 - 2(4x_7/7 + x_{11}/11 + x_{59}/59 + x_{4691}/4691) - 2v/P$. Only necessity of these real inequalities is used in the exclusion.

8.2 Only one useful projected pair at the proposed budget

Let $B = 6493223$ and, by negation, assume $j > 0$. The congruence lattice $\Gamma = \{(j, v) \in \mathbb{Z}^2 : j \equiv 3dv \pmod{P}\}$ has index P . The columns

$$u = (133972, 1649929), \quad z = (-2158411, 568941)$$

belong to Γ and have determinant P , hence form a basis. Their values of $(3dv - j)/P$ are 29 and 10.

Equation (36) implies

$$1 \leq j \leq \left\lfloor \frac{(PL + 2d)B}{T} \right\rfloor = 133972.$$

If $(j, v) = \alpha u + \beta z$, then

$$\beta = \frac{133972v - 1649929j}{P}, \quad |\beta| \leq \frac{133972(B + 1649929)}{P} < 1.$$

Therefore $\beta = 0$ and $\alpha = 1$. Every useful vector of norm at most B , up to negation, projects to u . The same cover applies to every smaller budget.

8.3 The affine phase and all twenty minimizers

Write $(p_i) = (7, 11, 59, 4691)$ and $(e_i) = (4, 1, 1, 1)$. For a projected pair define

$$t = \frac{3dv - j}{P}, \quad r_i \equiv -t(3e_i(d/p_i))^{-1} \pmod{p_i}, \quad 0 \leq r_i < p_i.$$

Substitution in $F = 0$ reduces it to

$$47x_3 = H_0 + 3 \sum_i e_i y_i, \quad H_0 = \frac{t + \sum_i 3e_i(d/p_i)r_i}{d}, \quad x_{p_i} = r_i + p_i y_i.$$

The residues make H_0 integral. Choose $0 \leq x_0 < 3$ with $47x_0 \equiv H_0 \pmod{3}$, and put $\theta = (47x_0 - H_0)/3$, $C_0 = (hj + 94x_0)/3$. This last number is integral: modulo three, $dP \equiv -1$ and $Pt \equiv -j$ give $H_0 \equiv j$, while $47x_0 \equiv H_0$ gives $x_0 \equiv 2j$. Every lift is uniquely

$$x_2 = C_0 + 94n, \quad x_3 = x_0 + 3n, \quad x_{p_i} = r_i + p_i y_i, \quad x_P = v, \quad 4y_7 + y_{11} + y_{59} + y_{4691} = \theta + 47n. \quad (37)$$

The derivation reverses, proving sufficiency as well.

For u , the data are

$$t = 29, \quad (r_i) = (5, 2, 47, 2335), \quad H_0 = 13, \quad x_0 = 2, \quad \theta = 27, \quad C_0 = 15317528.$$

Let

$$\ell_i(B) = \left\lfloor \frac{-B - r_i}{p_i} \right\rfloor, \quad U_i(B) = \left\lfloor \frac{B - r_i}{p_i} \right\rfloor, \quad \mathcal{L}(B) = \sum_i e_i \ell_i(B), \quad N_+(B) = \left\lfloor \frac{B - C_0}{94} \right\rfloor.$$

Every bounded lift must have $\mathcal{L}(B) \leq 27 + 47n$ and $n \leq N_+(B)$. The exact first-contact calculation is

budget	$\mathcal{L}$	N_+	$27 + 47N_+$
6493222	-4412144	-93876	-4412145
6493223	-4412148	-93876	-4412145

The first row excludes every lift at the preceding budget. At $B = 6493223$ the lower bounds are

$$(\ell_i) = (-927604, -590293, -110055, -1384).$$

They and the source bound force $n = -93876$. Putting $y_i = \ell_i + d_i$ leaves

$$4d_7 + d_{11} + d_{59} + d_{4691} = 3, \quad d_i \geq 0.$$

All upper caps exceed three. Hence $d_7 = 0$, and the remaining three deficits are all nonnegative compositions of three. There are $\binom{5}{2} = 10$. The resulting vectors are

$$\begin{aligned} x_2 &= 6493184, & x_3 &= -281626, & x_7 &= -6493223, \\ x_{11} &= -6493221 + 11d_{11}, & x_{59} &= -6493198 + 59d_{59}, \\ x_{4691} &= -6490009 + 4691d_{4691}, & x_P &= 1649929, \end{aligned} \tag{38}$$

where $d_{11} + d_{59} + d_{4691} = 3$. Each satisfies the original rows and has norm B . Their negatives give the other ten; the two lists are disjoint because $W \neq 0$. The complete projected cover and preceding-budget exclusion prove the useful minimum and completeness of this list.

8.4 The primitive minimum and its entire optimizer fibre

First use $j = 1$, so $W = -\mathcal{D}$. The congruence $3dv \equiv 1 \pmod{P}$ has centered representative

$$v_0 = -1358381707976, \quad 2|v_0| < P.$$

Every such vector has norm at least $M = |v_0|$; within budget M its pivot is necessarily v_0 . The negative primitive fibre has

$$t = -23875615, \quad (r_i) = (2, 8, 25, 1937), \quad H_0 = 7, \quad x_0 = 2, \quad \theta = 29, \quad C_0 = 177.$$

In particular

$$(-177, -2, -2, -327, -25, -1937, 1358381707976)$$

has $F = 0$, $W = \mathcal{D}$ and norm M , proving the primitive minimum.

For completeness, all positive primitive minimizers are precisely the negatives of

$$\begin{aligned} (177 + 94n, 2 + 3n, 2 + 7y_7, 8 + 11y_{11}, 25 + 59y_{59}, 1937 + 4691y_{4691}, -M), \\ 4y_7 + y_{11} + y_{59} + y_{4691} = 29 + 47n, \quad n, y_7, y_{11}, y_{59}, y_{4691} \in \mathbb{Z}, \end{aligned} \tag{39}$$

subject to absolute value at most M in each coordinate. This is a bounded affine parametrization, not an enumeration. Its completeness follows from the unique pivot representative and (37). The last coordinate ensures every admitted vector has norm exactly M . Finally (35) gives $\text{rad}(abc)/c = 6/343$. The ratio of the two costs exceeds 200000, but a single example, however large, proves no unboundedness in a restricted infinite family.

9 Open questions, scope and reproducibility

Question 9.1. Is $m_{\text{prim}}(2, 3^k)/m(2, 3^k)$ unbounded as k ranges over positive integers?

Question 9.2. Is $m_{\text{prim}}(a, b)/m(a, b)$ unbounded over coprime triples $a+b=c$ with $\text{rad}(abc) < c$?

Neither question is settled here. Theorem 1.1 supplies unbounded separation in a different family. The fixed-power question has the necessary simple-prime and non-Wieferich consequence in Theorem B.1. Conditional non-Wieferich results, such as [8, Theorems 1.2–1.4 in the cited arXiv version], do not give that consequence unconditionally or supply the returns. For the variable-base route to Question 9.2, (28) is the precise remaining existence target. The common domain and the comparison theorem remove a lifting obstruction but do not provide this sequence.

The arithmetic growth and Fourier bounds identify limitations of a specific certificate format. Larger finite records alone do not prove an infinite gap; an independent supply of simultaneous returns is still needed. The bounds leave open rare bases, other budget scales and collective frequency arguments. In particular no small-derivative estimate uniform over all triples, and no advance toward the abc conjecture, follows from these results.

The accompanying repository has a ten-minute reading path and a standard-library replay in `README_REVIEWER.md` and `REPRODUCE.md`. Its verifier checks the $k = 47$ factorization, lattice reduction, optimizer count and primitive fibre; the two variable-base minima and two finite spectral certificates; and literal small-cube controls for the prime-family theorem. Mutated certificates are rejected, and acceptance tests use explicit exceptions so that Python’s optimized mode does not disable them. Such finite checks support the indicated computations. The universal and density results rest on the written proofs and the explicitly attributed analytic input.

AI assistance. AI tools were used under the author’s direction for mathematical exploration, source comparison, proof criticism, drafting, exact computations and repository preparation. The accompanying `AI_USE.md` describes their scope. AI cross-review is not independent human peer review. The human author is responsible for the mathematics, attribution and any decision to publish.

A Proof of the common density domain

We prove Theorem 5.3. All auxiliary bounds are fixed before the base tends to infinity.

A.1 The analytic input and its counting consequence

We use the weighted estimate in Pascadi [7, Sections 6.1 and 6.3, Notations 20 and 23, (6.20) and the concluding strict margin], with these locators referring to the cited arXiv version. For a fixed nonnegative nonzero smooth weight at most one on $[1, 2]$, the full log-prime mass has a main term proportional to $X \log X$, and its truncation at a constant multiple of $X^{1.3}$ misses a fixed positive proportion. We import that estimate and its analytic and numerical ingredients. The following counting consequence is a deduction from the weighted proof, not from bare infinitude.

Each integer $x \leq 4X$ contributes at most $\sum_{p|x^2+1} \log p \leq \log(x^2+1) \leq 3 \log X$ for large X . For fixed $1 < \alpha < 1.3$, the prime threshold exceeds $(4X)^\alpha$ eventually. Thus some $\eta_0 > 0$ satisfies, for every sufficiently large X ,

$$\#\{x \in [X, 4X] : P^+(x^2+1) > x^\alpha\} \geq \eta_0 X. \quad (40)$$

No restriction on progressions, on prime bases, or on their modular phase distribution is imported.

A.2 Small exceptional sets for cosocles and anchors

For an odd prime p , the condition that p^2 divide one of $x, x-1, x+1, x^2+1$ occupies at most five classes modulo p^2 . The quadratic has at most two roots, each with a unique lift. For $x \leq Z$, such a prime is at most $Z+1$; therefore the number of bases with a repeated prime $p > T$ in any of the four values is at most

$$5Z \sum_{m>T} m^{-2} + 5\pi(Z+1) \leq 5Z/T + 5\pi(Z+1). \quad (41)$$

Here $\pi(Z) = o(Z)$ suffices. One elementary proof fixes a product Q of small primes: apart from finitely many exceptions primes are coprime to Q , so the upper density is at most $\varphi(Q)/Q$. This tends to zero, since the inverse Euler product contains growing partial harmonic sums. No prime number theorem is needed.

For fixed T , exclusion of divisibility of any of the four values by p^{E+1} for $p \leq T$ has upper density at most $\sum_{p \leq T} 5/p^{E+1}$. This is also a valid bound at 2 when $E \geq 1$, since the quadratic has no root modulo four. Given $\varepsilon > 0$, choose T and then E to make the sum of these two upper-density bounds less than ε . Outside the exclusions each cosocle is bounded by $B_0 = \prod_{p \leq T} p^{E-1}$, and so $H_0 \leq B_0^3$. The degree-two upper bound on p in (41) is essential; this argument is not applied to the growing-degree b .

For fixed Y , CRT gives exact natural densities for the absence of small simple primes in x , and in x^2+1 with $p \equiv 1 \pmod{4}$:

$$a(Y) = \prod_{p \leq Y} \left(1 - \frac{p-1}{p^2}\right), \quad b(Y) = \prod_{\substack{p \leq Y \\ p \equiv 1 \pmod{4}}} \left(1 - \frac{2(p-1)}{p^2}\right). \quad (42)$$

For the second formula, above each of the two roots modulo p there are $p-1$ lifts of valuation exactly one. Both products tend to zero. For clarity the needed divergence in the class 1 (mod 4) can be proved by the Euler products, for $s > 1$:

$$\log \zeta(s) + \log L(s, \chi_4) = 2 \sum_{p \equiv 1 \pmod{4}} p^{-s} + O(1), \quad s \downarrow 1.$$

The higher prime powers contribute a bounded term. The alternating series $L(s, \chi_4) = 1 - 3^{-s} + 5^{-s} - \dots$ converges uniformly for $s \geq 1$ and lies between $2/3$ and 1, so its logarithm is bounded. The divergence of $\zeta(s)$ proves $\sum_{p \equiv 1 \pmod{4}} 1/p = \infty$. Use $\log(1-t) \leq -t$ in (42). Independence of the two anchor events is not needed.

A.3 All large primes paid by reciprocal mass

We claim, for integer $X \geq 2$,

$$\sum_{x=2}^X \sigma_b < 20X, \quad \sum_{x=2}^X (\sigma_x + \sigma_b) < 21X. \quad (43)$$

For an odd prime $p \leq X$, put

$$R_p = \text{rad}_{\text{odd}}(p-1), \quad c_p = \begin{cases} 2, & p \equiv 3 \pmod{4}, \\ 4, & p \equiv 1 \pmod{4}, \end{cases} \quad m_p = c_p R_p, \quad \delta_p = \frac{c_p}{p} \prod_{\ell | R_p} (2 - 1/\ell).$$

The condition $p \mid b$ says that $d = \text{ord}_p(x)$ divides $N(x)$. It is equivalent to $d = 2^j r \mid m_p$ with r odd squarefree and $r \mid x+1$. For each such d , the $\varphi(d)$ order- d classes modulo p combine

with $x = -1 \pmod{r}$ into as many progressions modulo pr . Summing gives $\sum_{d|m_p} \varphi(d) = m_p$ progressions and total density

$$\frac{1}{p} \sum_j \varphi(2^j) \sum_{r|R_p} \frac{\varphi(r)}{r} = \delta_p.$$

Thus $\#\{2 \leq x \leq X : p \mid b\} \leq X\delta_p + m_p$. Since $m_p \mid p-1$ and $\prod_{\ell|R_p} (2 - 1/\ell) \leq 2^{\omega(p-1)} \leq 2\sqrt{p-1}$, one has $\delta_p/p < 8p^{-3/2}$. The sum of the weighted counts for odd $p \leq X$ is less than $8X \sum_{n \geq 3} n^{-3/2} + \pi(X) < 13X$; the prime 2 adds at most $X/2$. For primes $p > X$, on each individual base

$$\sum_{\substack{p|b \\ p > X}} \frac{1}{p} \leq \frac{\log b}{X \log X} < \frac{4(x+1) \log x}{X \log X} \leq 6.$$

This proves the first bound. Finally $\sum_{x=2}^X \sigma_x = \sum_{p \leq X} \lfloor X/p \rfloor / p < X$, giving the second. The estimate includes every prime divisor of b ; it asserts no tightness for its cosocle.

A.4 Simultaneous selection

Take $\varepsilon = \eta_0/64$. Choose the cosocle bound K so that its exceptional upper density is less than ε , and then fix Y with $a(Y) + b(Y) < \varepsilon$. For all sufficiently large X , each of these two exceptional counts up to $4X$ is less than $8\varepsilon X = \eta_0 X/8$. Choose $L > 336/\eta_0$. Markov's inequality and (43) bound its exception up to $4X$ by $84X/L < \eta_0 X/4$. Subtracting their union from (40) leaves at least $\eta_0 X/2$ bases in $[X, 4X]$. Taking X near $Z/4$ proves positive lower natural density of the globally defined selected set.

Its simple quadratic anchor $p_b \equiv 1 \pmod{4}$ has order four, does not divide N , and stays simple in b by the valuation formula. The same holds for $P > x^\alpha > x$. Eventually $P > Y$ so it is different from the small anchor. The source has its required simple anchor by construction, proving every assertion of Theorem 5.3.

B A full-domain bound in the fixed-power family

The following necessary condition helps separate the fixed-power open problem from the prime-family theorem.

Theorem B.1. *For $k \geq 1$, let P_1 be the largest prime of exponent exactly one in $c = 3^k + 2$, with $P_1 = 0$ if there is none. Then*

$$1 \leq \frac{m_{\text{prim}}(2, 3^k)}{m(2, 3^k)} < 32 \max(5, P_1)^3. \quad (44)$$

Unbounded ratios in this family would consequently imply that at least one of the fixed bases 2, 3 has infinitely many non-Wieferich primes. This is a necessary consequence, not a converse.

Proof. Take $k \geq 2$ and write

$$\begin{aligned} T &= 3^{k-1}, & e_p &= v_p(c), & A_p &= ce_p/p, & h_c &= c/\text{rad}(c), \\ g &= \gcd_p A_p, & \ell &= \text{lcm}_p e_p, & h &= \gcd(kc, 3g), & t &= g/h_c, \end{aligned}$$

$$\lambda = \sum_{p|c} e_p/p, \quad a_0 = 1 + 2\lambda, \quad \nu = \frac{hT}{ca_0}.$$

Eliminating z_2 from F gives $W/T = kcz_3 - 3 \sum A_p z_p$, so $\mathcal{D} = Th$. Also $h_c \mid h$ and $t \mid \ell$: at a prime dividing $\text{rad}(c)$ inspect its own coefficient $e_p \text{rad}(c)/p$, and at any other prime inspect the

minimum valuation among the e_p . The identity $W = 2 \sum A_p z_p - c z_2$ on $F = 0$ gives $m \geq \nu$. A real primitive lift is

$$z_2^* = -\nu, \quad z_p^* = \nu \ (p \mid c), \quad y^* = z_3^* = \frac{(c\lambda + 1)\nu}{kT}.$$

It has norm ν : all primes of c are at least five, $c < 5^k$ gives $\lambda < k/5$, and $k(2c - 10) \geq 24 > 15$ for $c \geq 11$ proves $c\lambda + 1 \leq kT$.

Choose y in the solution class $kcy = h \pmod{3g}$ nearest y^* . Its period is $3g/h$, hence $|y - y^*| \leq 3g/(2h)$. Then $z_2 = (2ky - h)/3$ is integral and $U = (kcy - h)/3 \in g\mathbb{Z}$. The real c -row with all coordinates $v = \nu + k(y - y^*)/(3\lambda)$ has target U . Put $P_p = p\ell/e_p$ and $Q = c\ell$, so $A_p P_p = Q$. Start from any integer lift of U , keep its residue classes modulo P_p , and round v down in each class. The deficit divided by Q is an integer in $\{0, \dots, \omega(c) - 1\}$, since it is a sum of fractional parts. There are more positive fractional parts than the integer deficit unless it is zero. Rounding that many coordinates with positive fractional part up once gives an exact lift with $|z_p - v| < P_p$ in every coordinate. Thus, with $P_{\max} = \max P_p$,

$$m_{\text{prim}} \leq \nu + \frac{kg}{h} \left(1 + \frac{1}{2\lambda}\right) + P_{\max}.$$

Dividing by $m \geq \nu$, using $c/T \leq 5$ and $h \geq h_c$, yields

$$\frac{m_{\text{prim}}}{m} \leq 1 + 5a_0 k \frac{t}{h_c} \left(1 + \frac{1}{2\lambda}\right) + 5a_0 \frac{P_{\max}}{h_c}. \quad (45)$$

Put $M = \max(5, P_1)$, let B_s be the product of the simple primes, and set $v_0 = \log h_c$. Then

$$c \leq B_s h_c^2, \quad k < 3M + 2v_0, \quad \lambda_s \leq M/5, \quad \lambda \leq M/5 + v_0.$$

Here $\log B_s \leq \sum_{p \leq M} \log p < 3M$ follows from the dyadic binomial bound: each interval $(2^{j-1}, 2^j]$ contributes at most $\log \binom{2^j}{2^{j-1}} < 2^j \log 2$, whose sum up to the next power of two is less than $4M \log 2 < 3M$. For repeated primes $p \geq 5, e \geq 2$,

$$e \leq p^{(e-1)/2}, \quad e/p^{e-1} \leq 2/5, \quad e^2/p^e \leq 4/25.$$

Each follows at $e = 2$ and then by successive ratios. In particular $t \leq \ell \leq \sqrt{h_c}$. The elementary maxima $v_0 e^{-v_0/2} < 1$ and $v_0^2 e^{-v_0/2} < 3$ give

$$a_0 k / \sqrt{h_c} < \frac{6}{5} M^2 + \frac{49}{5} M + 14 \leq 4M^2. \quad (46)$$

We also have

$$a_0 P_{\max} / h_c < M^2. \quad (47)$$

To see this, write $f_{p,e} = e/p^{e-1}$. For a selected simple p , $P_p/h_c \leq M \prod_{q \text{ repeated}} f_q$ and, if there are n repeated primes, $\lambda_{\text{rep}} P_p/h_c \leq (4M/25)n(2/5)^{n-1} \leq 4M/25$ (the sum is zero for $n = 0$). Thus $a_0 P_p/h_c \leq M(1 + 2M/5 + 8/25) < M^2$. For a repeated selected p , $P_p/h_c \leq 1$; its own contribution to $\lambda_{\text{rep}} P_p/h_c$ is at most $2/5$, and all other ones together at most $4/25$. Hence $a_0 P_p/h_c \leq 1 + 2M/5 + 28/25 < M^2$, proving (47).

If $B_s > 1$, $\lambda \geq 1/M$, and (46) bounds the first error in (45) by $20M^2(1 + M/2) \leq 14M^3$. Together with (47) this gives $m_{\text{prim}}/m < 16M^3$. If $B_s = 1$, $c = 2 \pmod{3}$ is not a square, so some repeated exponent e_p is odd and at least three. Since $\lambda \geq e_p/p$,

$$\frac{\ell}{h_c \lambda} \leq p^{2-e_p} \prod_{q \neq p} \frac{e_q}{q^{e_q-1}} \leq h_c^{-1/2}.$$

Now $k < 2v_0$, $a_0 \leq 1 + 2v_0$, and the first error in (45) is less than $(15/2)(2v_0 + 4v_0^2)e^{-v_0/2} < 105$. With $M = 5$, (47) gives $m_{\text{prim}}/m < 231 < 32M^3$. For $k = 1$, direct substitution gives $m = 1, m_{\text{prim}} = 2$.

Finally, for $p \geq 5$ dividing $3^k + 2$, put $f_p(a) = (a^{p-1} - 1)/p \pmod{p}$. Raising $3^k = -2 + p((3^k + 2)/p)$ to $p - 1$ modulo p^2 yields

$$(3^k + 2)/p \equiv 2(kf_p(3) - f_p(2)) \pmod{p}.$$

If p is simple, the left side is nonzero, so p is non-Wieferich to at least one of 2, 3. An unbounded ratio forces unbounded P_1 by (44); a union of two finite sets is finite. This proves the fixed-base alternative. $\square$

C Weighted covering of the type- A lattice

Let $r \geq 2$, $q_1, \dots, q_r > 0$, and

$$H = \{y \in \mathbb{R}^r : \sum_i y_i = 0\}, \quad A_{r-1} = H \cap \mathbb{Z}^r, \quad N_q(y) = \max_i q_i |y_i|.$$

We retain the following as a useful geometric proposition, with its metric explicit. It is not required by the minimum certificate in Section 8.

Proposition C.1. *The covering radius is*

$$\mu(A_{r-1}, N_q) = \max \left\{ \frac{1}{2} \max_i q_i, \frac{r-1}{\sum_i 1/q_i} \right\}. \quad (48)$$

For $r = 1$ the radius is zero instead.

Proof. Let μ_* be the right side. For $y \in H$, set

$$l_i = \lceil y_i - \mu_*/q_i \rceil, \quad u_i = \lfloor y_i + \mu_*/q_i \rfloor.$$

Each interval contains an integer, since $2\mu_*/q_i \geq 1$. The floor inequality gives

$$\sum_i u_i \geq \left\lfloor \mu_* \sum_i 1/q_i \right\rfloor - (r-1) \geq 0.$$

Applied to $-y$, it gives $\sum_i l_i \leq 0$. Sums of integer intervals have no holes, so integers $z_i \in [l_i, u_i]$ can be chosen with sum zero. This proves the upper bound.

For a maximal-weight index i and $j \neq i$, take $y_i = 1/2, y_j = -1/2$ and all other coordinates zero. Its distance to every integer vector is at least $q_i/2$. For the other bound put $R_0 = (r-1)/\sum_i 1/q_i$, and choose $y_1 = -R_0/q_1, y_i = 1 - R_0/q_i$ for $i > 1$. This point lies in H . If $N_q(y - z) < R_0$, then $z_1 < 0$ and $z_i < 1$ for $i > 1$. For integer z this implies $\sum_i z_i \leq -1$, impossible. Both lower bounds follow. $\square$

For pairwise coprime integers $q_i \geq 2$, put $Q = \prod_i q_i$ and $w_i = Q/q_i$. Modular reduction gives

$$\ker_{\mathbb{Z}} w = \text{diag}(q_i) A_{r-1}.$$

The diagonal map transports the original maximum norm to N_q . Since $\gcd_i w_i = 1$, every integer target t has a lift. Its real minimum is $\rho(t) = |t|/\sum_i w_i$. If $m_w(t) = \min_{wx=t, x \in \mathbb{Z}^r} \|x\|_{\infty}$, then

$$\lceil \rho(t) \rceil \leq m_w(t) \leq \lfloor \rho(t) + \mu(A_{r-1}, N_q) \rfloor. \quad (49)$$

For the upper bound, subtract any integer lift from a real minimizer, approximate the resulting point of the kernel by a kernel lattice point, and translate back. The norm of an integer vector is integral.

Prescribed-sum rounding is studied by Cont and Heidari [6, §§3.1–3.5], including common or symmetric losses. Unequal coordinate weights in a maximum norm do not give a symmetric loss under coordinate permutations, so that comparison is not an automatic import of (48). No priority claim for the formula is made here. Furthermore, a covering radius controls distance from arbitrary points of the real kernel. It cannot be substituted for a radial lifting overhead, or assigned to a projected fibre, without identifying both the actual difference lattice and the transported norm.

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